

FOUNDER-FACING SOURCE OF TRUTH

hostwhisperer

Launch Roadmap

Alfred — the multi-agent assistant engine, taken from working product to launched SaaS. Nine workstreams across four milestones, sequenced by readiness, every item tiered by urgency.

"Give yourself the gift of time."

- M0 · Harden
- M1 · Beta-Ready
- M2 · Closed Beta
- M3 · Public + V2
- Horizon · V3

Version 1.1	Status	Owner
Updated 2026-06-30	Active — pre-closed-beta	Founder · Execution by AG agents

1 How to use this document

This is the single source of truth for getting Alfred from "working product" to "launched SaaS." It is organized as **9 parallel tracks** mapped across **4 milestones** (+ a Horizon).

- **Milestones (M0 → M3)** answer "*when / in what order.*" Sequenced by **readiness**, not dates — each milestone's exit criteria unlock the next.
- **Tracks** answer "*what kind of work.*" They run in parallel; a milestone is "done" when every track has cleared its cell.
- The **Strategic Risk Register** (§9) holds existential/strategic exposures and lean mitigations.
- The **Open Decisions register** (§10) holds blockers that gate downstream work.
- The **Operating Model** (§8) defines the autopilot: PM agent + supporting agents.

Priority tiers — every added item is tagged so you know what's load-bearing vs optional:

NECESSARY must clear before its milestone ships; legal, financial, data-safety, or guest-trust critical.

HELPFUL materially de-risks or accelerates; do when bandwidth allows.

NICE later; scale- or revenue-gated.

Anti-over-engineering principle: bias to **buy-not-build** and the simplest solution that clears the bar. Most "necessary" items are a *decision* or a *toggle*, not a system to build — use managed providers (Stripe Tax, a merchant-of-record, hosted status page, provider safety filters). An "agent" is a prompt + a trigger, not a service.

2 Naming & brand architecture

Resolved decision (2026-06-30):

Name	Role
Alfred	The engine / assistant persona — the AI guests and hosts talk to. Internal + in-product.
HostWhisperer	The public product & company brand — landing page, marketing, billing, domain.

The HostWhisperer brand identity already exists (see `_Context/Design inspo/Brand_ID_guidelines.md`): ethereal glassmorphism, deep obsidian canvas, AI-aurora mesh gradients, "the Invisible Proxy" persona.

Tagline anchor: "Give yourself the gift of time."

3 Where we are now (snapshot)

The product largely exists and runs. The full V1 loop is live: ingest (host files + Airbnb scrape) → merge/conflict resolution → vectorized "Brain" → guest chat → escalation / Live Tunnel → self-learning loop → host dashboard (Flutter) + guest web app (Next.js/Vercel). RLS is enforced with booking-scoped guest JWTs.

We are effectively at **Phase 6 of 7** of the V1 build. Remaining work is **hardening + go-to-market + the business/trust layer**, not net-new core product. See `_Context/session-digest.md` for live engineering state.

4 Milestone spine

M0 Harden & Ship

Close out work in flight; get the current system onto solid ground. **No new product.**

Exit: staging verified e2e under JWT; prod env vars set; `staging-main` merged; DB reset plan ready; QA intake promoted; backups + 2FA verified; uptime monitors green.

M1 Beta-Ready

Everything a real human needs before touching Alfred: brand, landing/waitlist, legal + privacy, final UX, mobile, infra migrated, AI guardrails, agents stood up.

Exit: brand applied; landing + waitlist live; ToS + Privacy published; security review passed; mobile-optimized; Cloud Run migrated; self-serve onboarding works; restore tested; PM + QA agents live.

M2 Closed Beta

Invite 20–30 properties (family / partners). Observe, support, learn, iterate. **WhatsApp + Telegram go live here** — the channels beta testers actually use.

Exit: cohort onboarded; WA/TG live; feedback loop running; stability acceptable; conversion/retention signal captured.

M3 Public Launch + begin V2

Open to paying customers; add the V2 scale stack public volume requires.

Exit: billing + tax live; marketing campaign shipped; V2 scale stack deployed; load-tested.

V3 Horizon

OTA channel-manager integration + advanced automation. See §11.

5 The matrix (tracks × milestones)

Track	M0 · Harden	M1 · Beta-Ready	M2 · Closed Beta	M3 · Public + V2
1. Engineering & Infra	Redeploy staging, verify guest chat e2e under JWT, test soft-delete, prod env vars, staging→main, DB reset	Cloud Run migration, self-serve onboarding, harden error states, NEC AI guardrails + per-tenant rate limit	WhatsApp + Telegram live , beta stability fixes	V2: Redis/BullMQ queues, Sentry/Axiom, Resend, PostHog, scale-out
2. Brand & Identity	Lock name (done), secure domain	Finalize logo/wordmark, apply glassmorphism design system	—	Brand refresh for public
3. Marketing & Growth	—	Landing page (brief §7), value prop, waitlist	Beta testimonials, referral seeds	Launch campaign, pricing page, SEO/content, paid acquisition
4. UX/UI & Mobile	—	Final UI pass, mobile optimization, onboarding UX	Usability fixes from beta	Polish
5. Privacy, Security & Trust	NEC Finalize ToS	NEC Privacy Policy, cookie taxonomy + consent banner, document RLS, security review, bucket/retention audit	DPA / consent ops (if EU), incident response basics	SLA, compliance hardening
6. QA, Maintenance & Reliability	Promote intake → scenarios, run Layer 1, uptime monitors	Layer 2 Playwright, dedicated QA agent (§8), HELP AI answer eval set, QA-matrix evolution	Beta monitoring + triage	Regression suite, load test (200 concurrent)
7. Agent Operations	Define operating model (hybrid)	Stand up PM agent + near-term agents (§8)	Autopilot during beta, escalate decisions	Tune autonomy
8. Business & Money	—	NEC Legal entity + tax/billing approach, NEC unit-economics sketch, HELP pricing decision	(free beta — billing optional)	NEC Billing + tax live, HELP insurance, NICE AUP/SLA

Track	M0 · Harden	M1 · Beta-Ready	M2 · Closed Beta	M3 · Public + V2
9. Reliability & Continuity	NEC Verify backups + 2FA/secrets audit	NEC Test a restore + email deliverability (SPF/DKIM/DMARC), HELP status page	HELP Incident runbook + on-call alerting	NICE DR drill, SLA

6 Track detail

Track 1 — Engineering & Infra

Objective: a stable, scalable backend that runs without firefighting.

- **M0:** Redeploy staging; verify guest chat e2e under booking JWT; test soft-delete/anonymization; set prod env vars (`SUPABASE_JWT_SECRET` , `PYTHON_VERSION=3.12.10`); merge `staging→main` ; prepare clean DB reset.
- **M1:** Cloud Run migration; self-serve signup + guided onboarding; harden error states.
- **NEC** **AI guardrails (keep simple):** per-conversation/tenant **rate limit** (a counter, not a quota engine) to cap runaway cost/abuse; **high-stakes-field fallback** — for address, access codes, checkout, Alfred uses only confirmed Master-JSON data or says "let me confirm with your host" rather than guessing; lean on the **provider's built-in safety filters** for moderation; basic system-prompt hardening against injection.
No ML moderation pipeline.
- **M2:** **NEC** **WhatsApp + Telegram live.** *Dependency:* WhatsApp Business API needs Meta verification — **start in M1** (R/D2). Telegram has no gate.
- **M3:** V2 scale stack — Redis cache + BullMQ queues, Sentry + Axiom, Resend, PostHog.

Track 2 — Brand & Identity

Objective: one coherent HostWhisperer identity.

- **M0:** Name locked; secure domain + handles.
- **M1:** Finalize wordmark (**host** bold / *whisperer* light) + key/waves symbol; codify design tokens; apply to dashboard, guest app, landing.
- **M3:** Refresh for public surface.

Track 3 — Marketing & Growth

Objective: strangers → waitlist → beta → paying hosts.

- **M1:** Landing page against the brief (§7); sharpen value prop; waitlist.
- **M2:** Beta testimonials / case studies; referral seeds.
- **M3:** Launch campaign, pricing page, SEO/content, paid acquisition.
- **HELP** **Foundation (M1, lightweight):** define **ICP** (property count, region, persona) and **North-Star metric + funnel** — one page each, not a research project.

Track 4 — UX/UI & Mobile

Objective: effortless on the devices people actually use.

- **M1:** Final UI pass (dashboard + guest app); **mobile optimization** (guests are phone-first); onboarding UX.

- **M2:** Usability fixes from beta. **M3:** Polish.
- **NICE** **Open:** native iOS/Android apps (Flutter can) add an app-store track — **default web-only until demand proves it** (D9).

Track 5 — Privacy, Security & Trust

Objective: legally and technically trustworthy before real data flows.

- **M0:** **NEC** Finalize ToS (`tos-draft.md` exists) — **include an AI-accuracy disclaimer** (R/R2).
- **M1:** **NEC** Privacy Policy; cookie taxonomy (functional/analytics/marketing) + consent banner wired to the real stack (only non-essential cookies post-consent); document data protection (RLS, soft-delete + anonymization already built); security review (security-review + insecure-defaults skills); bucket/retention audit.
- **M2:** DPA / consent ops *if EU guests* (conditional — D4); basic incident-response runbook.
- **M3:** SLA, compliance hardening.

Track 6 — QA, Maintenance & Reliability

Objective: quality holds automatically as the system changes.

- **M0:** Promote pending-intake → `_tests/scenarios.md`; run Layer 1; uptime monitors (UptimeRobot).
- **M1:** Layer 2 Playwright; **dedicated QA agent** (§8); evolve `scenarios.md` into the spec-first QA matrix; error monitoring.
- **HELP** **AI answer eval set (keep small):** ~20–30 fixed guest questions with expected-good answers; re-run on model changes to catch drift. Manual-to-start; distinct from UI QA.
- **M2:** Beta monitoring + triage. **M3:** Regression suite; load test (200 concurrent, p95 < 5s).

Track 7 — Agent Operations

Objective: Alfred-on-autopilot — agents run day-to-day, founder decides.

- **M0:** Operating model defined (hybrid). **M1:** Stand up PM agent + near-term agents (§8).
- **M2:** Autopilot through beta; escalate genuine decisions. **M3:** Tune autonomy.

Track 8 — Business & Money **NEW**

Objective: get paid, stay legal and solvent — with the least machinery.

- **NEC** **M1 — Legal entity + tax/billing approach (decision, not a build).** Pick a structure for liability protection; choose the billing path. *Keep it simple: a **merchant-of-record** (Paddle / Lemon Squeezy) or **Stripe + Stripe Tax** handles VAT/sales-tax registration and remittance for you — do **not** build tax logic.*
- **NEC** **M1 — Unit-economics sketch.** One spreadsheet: per-property COGS (Gemini/Claude/Pinecone/Apify/Firecrawl/infra) vs price, so pricing covers margin. Back-of-envelope, not a model.
- **HELP** **M1 — Pricing decision** — tiers, free-trial vs freemium (D3).
- **NEC** **M3 — Billing live** via the chosen provider (dunning, refunds, invoices, proration are the *provider's* job — don't build).

- **HELP** **M3 — Insurance** (E&O + cyber) once there's revenue/users to justify it — not before.
- **NICE** **M3+ — Acceptable Use Policy + SLA** (template-based).
- *Note: the closed beta (M2) can run **free** → billing isn't required until M3.*

Track 9 — Reliability & Continuity **NEW**

Objective: data is safe, outages are visible, and you're not a single point of failure.

- **NEC** **M0 — Verify backups + 2FA/secrets audit.** Confirm Supabase automated backups are on; enable **2FA on every vendor account** (Supabase/Render/Vercel/Pinecone/Apify/domain registrar); store creds + recovery codes in a password manager. *Nothing to build — just turn things on.*
- **NEC** **M1 — Test a restore once** (and document the steps); set up **email deliverability** (SPF/DKIM/DMARC on the domain) so mail lands.
- **HELP** **M1 — Status page** — use a hosted/free one; don't build.
- **HELP** **M2 — Incident runbook + on-call alerting** — wire existing uptime monitors to push to your phone; one-page runbook, not a system.
- **NICE** **M3 — DR drill + SLA commitments.**

7 Marketing principles brief

Evolutionary Marketing + Neuromarketing. A starting brief the landing-page work (Track 3, M1) builds against. **Basics now; deepen with research before execution.**

Evolutionary Marketing — core idea

Speak to deep, evolved drivers, not features. For premium STR owners: **status** (run a high-end operation effortlessly), **time/resource conservation** (reclaim hours), **risk/loss aversion** (never miss a message or a review), **tribe/belonging** (join smart operators). Frame the product as restoring *freedom and time*.

Neuromarketing — principles for the landing page

- **Cognitive ease / low friction** — negative space, one clear action per view.
- **Loss aversion framing** — dramatize the status-quo cost (missed messages, 2am pings, bad reviews) before relief.
- **Social proof** — beta testimonials, property counts, trust signals (M2 feeds this).
- **Anchoring** — pricing against the value of time saved / a property manager's fee.
- **Visual processing & gaze cueing** — serene, decluttered hero imagery; directional cues to the CTA.
- **Authority & calm** — the "Invisible Proxy" voice: serene assurance.

To research before building

- Evidence-based Neuromarketing landing patterns (CTA placement, contrast, hierarchy, scroll depth).
- Evolutionary-driver messaging tested in B2B SaaS / proptech.
- Competitor teardown (Hospitable, Besty, HostAI, etc.) — positioning gaps.
- STR host willingness-to-pay / pricing anchors.

8 Operating model (autopilot)

Goal: the platform runs mostly on automatic; the founder steers and decides.

Permanent PM agent — hybrid (scheduled + event-driven)

- **Scheduled:** daily check + weekly roadmap review — updates cell status, reports progress, surfaces blockers, proposes next actions.
- **Event-driven:** reacts to errors, founder feedback, PR merges, failed deploys, QA failures — acts or escalates.
- **Escalates for:** architectural decisions, spend, brand/positioning, anything in the registers (\$9–\$10).

Supporting agents

Agent	Trigger model	Tier · sequence	Responsibility
QA agent	Hybrid, event-primary	NEC M1	Pre-merge gate: Layer 1 on every <code>staging→main</code> PR, block on failure . Nightly/weekly full Layer 2 Playwright regression + report (catches realtime/free-tier + cold-start drift). On-demand too.
Release / deploy agent	Event-driven	HELP M1	Verified deploys (Render/Vercel/Cloud Run), confirm health, handle the Vercel manual-redeploy quirk, report status.
Support-triage agent	Event-driven	HELP M1–M2	Watch escalations + beta feedback; classify, draft responses, route real issues to founder/PM agent.
FinOps / cost agent	Scheduled daily + anomaly	NEC near-term	Watch API + infra spend, attribute cost per tenant, alert on runaway <i>before the bill does</i> . Protects margin (R3).
AI-quality / eval agent	Scheduled + on model change	HELP near-term	Run the eval set, score answer quality, catch drift when Gemini/Claude update (R2).
Incident / on-call agent	Event-driven	HELP near-term	First responder to outages: run diagnostics, draft status-page update, page founder only if it can't self-resolve.
Security / dependency agent	Scheduled + on PR	HELP around beta	Dependency vulns, secret-leak scans, RLS-regression checks, periodic security-review.
Customer-success / onboarding agent	Event + scheduled	HELP around beta	Detect stuck onboarding (property never trained), nudge hosts, health-check tenants.

Agent	Trigger model	Tier · sequence	Responsibility
Analytics / insights agent	Scheduled weekly	NICE post-beta	Metrics digest, funnel + churn-signal surfacing.
Growth / content agent	Scheduled	NICE post-beta	Draft SEO/content/build-in-public, competitor monitoring, waitlist nurture.
Compliance-watch agent	Scheduled	NICE later	Monitor Airbnb ToS changes, GDPR/EU AI Act, platform-policy shifts (R1).

Build order (don't build all at once): near-term = **PM, QA, FinOps, AI-quality, Incident** (protect money, trust, uptime). Around beta = Release, Support-triage, Security, Customer-success. Later = Analytics, Growth, Compliance-watch.

Over-engineering guard: add an agent only when the manual version of its job becomes a recurring drag. Each agent is a prompt + a trigger, not a microservice.

9 Strategic risk register

#	Risk	Severity	Lean mitigation	Tier
R1	Airbnb platform dependency / ToS — scraping + moving guests off-platform ("Trojan Horse") could violate policy; Airbnb could detect & block.	High / existential	Keep a low profile; treat Channex/OTA (V3) as the legitimate path ; hold a written "if Airbnb blocks us" thesis; don't over-invest in fragile scraping. Compliance-watch agent monitors policy.	NEC now
R2	AI gives wrong/harmful answer (wrong code, checkout, address).	High	ToS accuracy disclaimer + high-stakes-field fallback (Track 1) + eval set (Track 6).	NEC
R3	Runaway AI cost / abuse — a spammer runs up your bill.	Med-High	Per-tenant rate limit (Track 1) + FinOps agent alerts.	NEC
R4	Vendor single points of failure — Gemini/Pinecone/Render/Apify/Firecrawl.	Med	Document dependencies; accept for now — don't build a multi-vendor abstraction prematurely; revisit if one proves unreliable.	HELP
R5	Founder unavailability (bus factor) — 24/7 service, one person.	Med	Runbooks + autopilot agents + recovery codes stored safely.	HELP
R6	Competition (Hospitable, Besty, HostAI).	Med	Clear ICP + differentiation (self-learning loop, Spanish/LATAM focus).	HELP

10 Open decisions / blockers register

#	Decision / blocker	Gates	Status
D1	Domain name + handles for HostWhisperer	Brand, landing, email	Open
D2	Start Meta Business verification for WhatsApp (days-weeks lead)	M2 WA channel	Open — start in M1
D3	Pricing model + free-trial vs freemium	M3 monetization; beta → paid	Open
D4	EU guests / GDPR scope (DPA, consent ops, cookie law)	Privacy M1/M2	Open

#	Decision / blocker	Gates	Status
D5	Tracking/analytics stack (PostHog + landing analytics)	Cookie taxonomy, consent banner	Open
D6	Cost & burn tracking (AI + infra scale with usage)	Sustainability; FinOps agent	Watch
D7	DB reset execution window before beta	M0 exit → M2	Open
D8	Legal entity + billing path (MoR vs Stripe+Stripe Tax)	Track 8; M3 billing	Open
D9	Native mobile apps vs web-only	M1/M3 UX scope	Open — default web-only

11 Horizon — V3

Parked; detail when M3 is in sight.

- **OTA / channel-manager integration (Channex.io)** — sync to Airbnb / Booking / VRBO through one layer instead of per-platform APIs. *Also the legitimate de-risk for R1.*
- **Dynamic pricing with a heat-map view** — recommended nightly pricing across dates/properties as a visual heat map.
- Cleaning-schedule automation, multi-language expansion (candidates).

Founder-facing source of truth. The PM agent keeps cell status current. Update exit criteria as scope firms up.